

The feast of unleavened bread

Exodus 12:3,6

³ Speak ye unto all the congregation of Israel, saying, **In the tenth day** of this month they shall take to them every man a lamb, according to the house of their fathers, a lamb for an house:

⁶ And ye shall keep it up until the **fourteenth day** of the same month: and the whole assembly of the congregation of Israel shall **kill it in the evening**.

⁸ And they shall eat the flesh **in that night**, roast with fire, and **unleavened bread**; and with bitter herbs they shall eat it.

Exodus 12:15-19

¹⁵ **Seven days** shall ye eat unleavened bread; even **the first day** ye shall put away leaven out of your houses: for whosoever eateth leavened bread from **the first day until the seventh day**, that soul shall be cut off from Israel.

¹⁶ And **in the first day** there shall be an holy convocation, and **in the seventh day** there shall be an holy convocation to you; no manner of work shall be done in them, save that which every man must eat, that only may be done of you.

¹⁷ And ye shall observe **the feast of unleavened bread**; for in this selfsame day have I brought your armies out of the land of Egypt: therefore shall ye observe this day in your generations by an ordinance for ever.

¹⁸ In the first month, **on the fourteenth day** of the month at even, ye shall eat unleavened bread, **until the one and twentieth day** of the month **at even**.

¹⁹ **Seven days** shall there be no leaven found in your houses: for whosoever eateth that which is leavened, even that soul shall be cut off from the congregation of Israel, whether he be a stranger, or born in the land.

- “*in the evening*” in the 1524 Bomberg MT Hebrew (בֵּין הָעֶרְבִים) reads “between the two evenings”.
- The first evening is afternoon. The second evening is the beginning of the next day (sunset).
- Otherwise, “*in the evening*” would be the 15th day.

Leviticus 23:4-8

⁴ These are the feasts of the LORD, even holy convocations, which ye shall proclaim in their seasons.

⁵ **In the fourteenth day** of the first month at even is the LORD'S passover.

⁶ And **on the fifteenth day** of the same month is **the feast of unleavened bread** unto the LORD: **seven days** ye must eat unleavened bread.

⁷ **In the first day** ye shall have an holy convocation: ye shall do no servile work therein.

⁸ But ye shall offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD **seven days**: **in the seventh day** is an holy convocation: ye shall do no servile work therein.

E = evening, M = morning, HC = holy convocation, LK = lamb killed, LE = lamb eaten, NL = leaven is to be removed this day

First Month																	
14 th		15 th		16 th		17 th		18 th		19 th		20 th		21 st		22 nd	
E	M	E	M	E	M	E	M	E	M	E	M	E	M	E	M	E	M
		Feast of unleavened bread															
Passover		1 st		2 nd		3 rd		4 th		5 th		6 th		7 th			
LK		HC, LE, NL												HC			

NOTE: the passover lamb is slain on the 14th during the day and then eaten very early on the first day of unleavened bread (after sunset; the 15th).

Time travel?

Matthew 26:17-21

¹⁷ Now the first day of the feast of unleavened bread the disciples came to Jesus, saying unto him, Where wilt thou that we prepare for thee to eat the passover?

¹⁸ And he said, Go into the city to such a man, and say unto him, The Master saith, My time is at hand; I will keep the passover at thy house with my disciples.

¹⁹ And the disciples did as Jesus had appointed them; and they made ready the passover.

²⁰ Now when the even was come, he sat down with the twelve.

²¹ And as they did eat, he said, Verily I say unto you, that one of you shall betray me.

- On the first day of the feast of unleavened bread which is the same as the 15th day of the month (Exodus 12:17,18) the disciples came and asked Jesus where they should prepare the passover (which was to be done on the 14th day; Exodus 12:6).
- Jesus rebuked them saying “sorry fellas, ya’ll are a day late and a dollar short”.
- Not exactly. Which is **very** interesting. Did the disciples and Jesus travel back in time to prepare the passover and then eat it (v18-21)?

If we look at the parallel passages in Mark and Luke we see:

Mark 14:12

And the first day of unleavened bread, when they killed the passover, his disciples said unto him, Where wilt thou that we go and prepare that thou mayest eat the passover?

Luke 22:7

Then came the day of unleavened bread, when the passover must be killed.

- But we know full well that the law states the passover lamb is to be killed on the 14th day at even (Exodus 12:6).
- Here we are plainly told that the first day of unleavened bread is the same day as the day the passover is killed.
- Evidently Matthew, Mark, and Luke all use the same Jewish colloquialism where all 8 days are referred to as “the feast of unleavened bread” instead of “the passover” (1 day) and “the feast of unleavened bread” (7 days) separately like in the OT.

The historian Flavius Josephus documented this colloquialism in “The Antiquities of the Jews”, Book 2, Chapter 15, Paragraph 1:

1. So the Hebrews went out of Egypt, while the Egyptians wept, and repented that they had treated them so hardly. - Now they took their journey by Letopolis, a place at that time deserted, but where Babylon was built afterwards, when Cambyses laid Egypt waste: but as they went away hastily, on the third day they came to a place called Beelzephon, on the Red Sea; and when they had no food out of the land, because it was a desert, they eat of loaves kneaded of flour, only warmed by a gentle heat; and this food they made use of for thirty days; for what they brought with them out of Egypt would not suffice them any longer time; and this only while they dispensed it to each person, to use so much only as would serve for necessity, but not for satiety. Whence it is that, in memory of the want we were then in, we keep a feast for eight days, which is called the feast of unleavened bread. Now the entire multitude of those that went out, including the women and children, was not easy to be numbered, but those that were of an age fit for war, were six hundred thousand.

A day to be remembered

Matthew 26:16-18 ¹⁶ And from that time he sought opportunity to betray him. ¹⁷ Now the first day of the feast of unleavened bread the disciples came to Jesus, saying unto him, Where wilt thou that we prepare for thee to eat the passover? ¹⁸ And he said, Go into the city to such a man, and say unto him, The Master saith, My time is at hand; I will keep the passover at thy house with my disciples.	Mark 14:11-13 ¹¹ And when they heard it, they were glad, and promised to give him money. And he sought how he might conveniently betray him. ¹² And the first day of unleavened bread, when they killed the passover, his disciples said unto him, Where wilt thou that we go and prepare that thou mayest eat the passover? ¹³ And he sendeth forth two of his disciples, and saith unto them, Go ye into the city, and there shall meet you a man bearing a pitcher of water: follow him. Mark 15:42 And now when the even was come, because it was the preparation, that is, the day before the sabbath,	Luke 22:6-8 ⁶ And he promised, and sought opportunity to betray him unto them in the absence of the multitude. ⁷ Then came the day of unleavened bread, when the passover must be killed. ⁸ And he sent Peter and John, saying, Go and prepare us the passover, that we may eat.	John 19:14 And it was the preparation of the passover, and about the sixth hour: and he saith unto the Jews, Behold your King!
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When we first read **John 19:14** we might think it's referring to the 10th day of the first month. But, because of **Mark 15:42**, and the fact that all four of these are parallel passages, and that they all occurred in the same year (**Luke 22:16,18**), we know they are all referring to the same day:

- The 15th day of the first month (when the passover is eaten).
- A Friday (the day before the sabbath).
- The first day of the feast of unleavened bread (Legal/Law reckoning).
- The second day of the feast of unleavened bread (Jewish custom).
- The preparation / the preparation of the passover.

Deuteronomy 21:22-23 (cf. Acts 5:30, 10:39, 2Cor 5:21, Gal 3:13, 1Pet 2:24) ²² And if a man have committed a sin worthy of death, and he be to be put to death, and thou hang him on a tree: ²³ His body shall not remain all night upon the tree, but thou shalt in any wise bury him that day; (for he that is hanged is accursed of God;) that thy land be not defiled, which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance.

Search **the scriptures**; for in them ye think ye have eternal life: and they are they which **testify of me**.